ENG-0003: Incident Postmortem for INC-067

Impact

The incident designated INC-067 affected the **auth-worker** system (System ID: SYS-004), which is a critical component within **Project Juniper**. Due to the severity level classified as Sev1, the impact was significant, resulting in service disruption that could potentially impair authentication processes across related services. The incident lasted for approximately 4.5 hours, during which users and internal stakeholders experienced degraded system performance. The disruption posed a risk to operational continuity and highlighted the importance of maintaining system stability within high-criticality environments.

Timeline

- **2025-01-15**: The incident was reported by Lisa Hensley, Head of Facilities, at approximately [time not specified], indicating an unexpected failure in the auth-worker system.
- **Incident Detection**: The incident was identified promptly following reports of service issues related to authentication.
- **Initial Response**: Crystal Robinson, Project Manager and on-call engineer for auth-worker, was mobilized to investigate the problem.
- **Diagnosis and Resolution**: The root cause was traced to a recent configuration change. Corrective actions were implemented, and the system was restored to normal operation.
- **Resolution Time**: The incident was resolved within 4.5 hours from initial detection.
- **Post-Resolution**: Monitoring confirmed system stability, and incident documentation was completed.

Root Cause

The root cause of the incident was identified as a configuration change applied to the auth-worker system. This change was categorized under "config_change" and directly led to the service disruption. The change was likely not adequately tested or validated prior to deployment, which resulted in the system's failure to operate as intended. This highlights the importance of rigorous change management procedures, especially for systems with high criticality such as auth-worker.

Action Items

Action Item	Responsible Party	Due Date	Notes
Review and reinforce change management procedures for config changes	Project Juniper Lead (E-090)	Immediate	Ensure all configuration changes undergo thorough testing and approval processes.
Implement additional monitoring and alerting for auth-worker	IT Operations Team	Within 2 weeks	

Action Item	Responsible Party	Due Date	Notes
			Enhance early detection capabilities to minimize downtime in future incidents.
Conduct a post-incident review and training session	Crystal Robinson	Within 1 week	Share lessons learned and best practices with relevant team members.
Schedule a system audit for auth-worker configuration	Internal Audit Team	Within 1 month	Verify current configurations and identify potential vulnerabilities.

Additional Notes

This incident underscores the importance of meticulous change control, especially within systems critical to enterprise operations. Crystal Robinson, who was on call during the incident, played a pivotal role in the swift diagnosis and resolution. The incident was reported by Lisa Hensley, whose prompt reporting facilitated rapid response. Going forward, the team will focus on strengthening change validation processes and enhancing system monitoring to prevent recurrence of similar incidents.

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